

CHUSEOK SPECIAL · HOLIDAY D-29

Four Days Off. The Math Is Done.

01 Close or Open? Your Neighborhood Knows

Office, residential, transit, tourist — a 4-quadrant verdict chart

02 One Day's P&L in a 30-Second Formula

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The Cheoseo Magic That Never Came

A heat advisory on Cheoseo day itself — autumn is late, so what should your bar postpone, and what should it prepare?

Editor's note — “Chuseok is still four weeks away” is exactly how holiday stock and staffing decisions lose their value. This issue is working equipment for making them now.

The Courage to Close for Four Days

When offices close, office dinners close too. This is what a business district looks like on a holiday morning — yet every year we stay open on a hunch that “something will come in.” This year, decide by arithmetic, not instinct.

Which Quadrant Is Your Bar In?

Two axes are enough: does your neighborhood empty out or fill up during the holiday, and does demand sit in the front half or the back half of the four days?

OFFICE / NIGHTLIFE DISTRICT Close Fully Your customer source — the offices — empties out entirely. Close all four days; save your firepower for the post-holiday dinner rebound.	TRANSIT HUB / TERMINAL Open the Last 2 Days Concentrate staff and stock on Sep 26–27, when returning travelers flow through.
RESIDENTIAL / APARTMENT AREA From Chuseok Evening Once the ancestral rites end on Chuseok evening, gathered families and stay-home singles come out into the neighborhood.	TOURIST AREA / HOTSPOT Scale Up A long holiday is peak season. Closing means surrendering it. Run stock and staff at 1.5× a normal weekend.

← PEOPLE LEAVE · PEOPLE ARRIVE →
Top row: shallow demand Bottom row: deep demand

If the verdict is unclear, open last year’s holiday POS data. If even one day beat 70% of your weekday average, that day’s pattern is your answer; if none did, the formula on the next page settles it.



FEATURE · THE RESIDENTIAL PLAY

The Holiday Customer Isn't Far Away. They're Home.

When the rite table is cleared, the drinking table follows. Singles who skipped the trip home, siblings reunited for once — from Chuseok evening onward, residential districts take over. Soju and beer, plus the cheongju that always moves before holidays: build your list around family-sized orders.

PHOTO · SEWANG EDITORIAL



“We’ll Make Something” Is How Holiday Losses Begin

Projected sales × margin

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That day’s labor × 1.5 + daily fixed costs

If the left side is bigger, open; if not, rest. Compute it day by day — treating the four days as one lump blurs the judgment.

Why ×1.5 on labor: under Korean law, workplaces with 5+ employees owe a 50% holiday-work premium on public holidays. Even below 5 staff, it is safer to assume holiday shifts carry real extra cost in pay or substitute leave.

Projected sales come from records, not hope. Last year’s same holiday is the first choice; failing that, 60–80% of a recent Sunday is a conservative starting point.

And if the number is a razor-thin profit — close anyway. Staff don’t quit the bar that lets them rest on holidays. In today’s labor market, no benefit is cheaper.

Four Days Without Deliveries: Count Backwards

Liquor distribution rests over the holiday too. If you're opening, four days of stock must arrive on the final delivery. Counted back from the last delivery day, Wed Sep 23.

Sep 15 TUE · D-9

Start securing holiday volume of shelf-stable items — bottled beer, soju, whisky, sake. The week before Chuseok, every account orders at once; stockouts and delays are common.

Sep 21–22 MON–TUE · D-3

Lock your holiday operating plan and pre-reserve volume with your sales rep. Tourist and transit locations: plan on 1.5× a normal weekend.

Sep 23 WED · LAST DELIVERY ★

Fresh items — draft kegs above all — arrive today. Check 1–2 spare kegs and your CO₂ level while you're at it.

Sep 24–27 HOLIDAY · NO DELIVERIES

Regular deliveries pause. But Sewang keeps **duty staff on call** through the holiday — if you run unexpectedly short, call your sales rep.

Sep 28 MON · DELIVERIES RESUME

Restock what the holiday consumed — and put late-September dinner-season volume on the same order.

※ Emergency support during the holiday runs through our duty roster. Item availability may be limited, so the safe play is to secure your core volume by Sep 23.

A Heat Advisory on Cheoseo: Autumn Is Running Late

Last issue we wrote that Cheoseo (Aug 23) would bring back whisky — down 12% all summer — and warm sake. The verdict first: this year’s “Cheoseo magic” didn’t fire. On Cheoseo day itself, Seoul sat under a heat advisory and daytime highs hit 32–35°C nationwide.

The weather service forecasts above-normal heat into early September. For a bar, that means the autumn switch is postponed — don’t rush to cut highballs and draft beer, and hold the warm-dishes-and-sake transition until the heat actually breaks.

The direction, though, is set. On the first weekend the heat breaks, check three signals: are whisky-on-the-rocks orders rising, is the preference for outdoor seats fading, are warm dishes moving first? One “yes” marks the turning point. We’ll follow up with measured data next issue.



Braised golden-eye snapper at Tokyo’s Nakizakana — once the heat breaks, this is the warmth hands reach for. (From our July benchmarking trip)

NEXT ISSUE

After the holiday comes the real season — the late-September dinner rebound and October’s autumn opener, with measured Cheoseo data. + **Korea’s liquor shipments at a 27-year low (NTS): the truth behind the number.**

A Partner That Grows With You

From holiday pre-orders to the post-holiday dinner season, your Sewang sales rep plans around your bar's situation. Founded in 1978 — nearly half a century of full-line liquor wholesale across Seoul and Gyeonggi.

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